

A vs An

CEFR A1

Lesson Pack · summary, worksheet & answer key

Quick answer

Choose a or an by the sound of the next word, not its spelling:

- 1 a + consonant sound — a dog, a university, a one-way street.
- 2 an + vowel sound — an egg, an hour, an honest answer.

Watch the tricky ones: 'u' can sound like 'you' (a university) and 'h' can be silent (an hour). Go by sound.

At a glance

Use	Sound	Examples
a	consonant sound	a car, a book, a house
an	vowel sound	an apple, an egg, an idea
a	'you' sound	a university, a European, a one-way street
an	silent h	an hour, an honest person, an honour

Learning objectives

- Can choose a/an by the following sound rather than spelling (CEFR A1).
- Can handle tricky cases: silent h, 'you' sound, and abbreviations.
- Can self-correct common a/an errors.



Practice worksheet

Circle the correct option. A vs An · CEFR A1

Name: _____

Date: _____

1. I'd like ____ apple, please.

- | | |
|--------|-------|
| A. a | B. an |
| C. the | D. — |

2. She studies at ____ university.

- | | |
|--------|------|
| A. an | B. a |
| C. the | D. — |

3. We waited for ____ hour.

- | | |
|--------|-------|
| A. a | B. an |
| C. the | D. — |

4. He's ____ honest man.

- | | |
|--------|-------|
| A. a | B. an |
| C. the | D. — |

5. That's ____ useful idea.

- | | |
|--------|------|
| A. an | B. a |
| C. the | D. — |

6. My uncle is ____ MP.

- | | |
|--------|-------|
| A. a | B. an |
| C. the | D. — |

7. They live in ____ European city.

- | | |
|--------|------|
| A. an | B. a |
| C. the | D. — |

8. Correct this: 'She had an one-hour meeting.'

- | | |
|--------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| A. She had a one-hour meeting. | B. She had an one-hour meeting. |
| C. She had one-hour meeting. | D. She had the one-hour meeting. |

9. There's ____ umbrella by the door.

- | | |
|--------|-------|
| A. a | B. an |
| C. the | D. — |

10. Which pair is correct?

- | | |
|--------------------------|--------------------------|
| A. an hour, a university | B. a hour, an university |
| C. an university, a hour | D. a hour, a university |

Answer key

Correct answers with explanations · for the teacher

1. **B. an** — 'An apple' — vowel sound.
2. **B. a** — 'A university' — the 'you' sound is a consonant sound.
3. **B. an** — 'An hour' — silent h means a vowel sound.
4. **B. an** — 'An honest man' — silent h.
5. **B. a** — 'A useful idea' — the 'you' sound is a consonant sound.
6. **B. an** — 'An MP' — the letter M sounds like 'em'.
7. **B. a** — 'A European city' — the 'you' sound.
8. **A. She had a one-hour meeting.** — 'One' starts with a 'wun' sound (a consonant sound) → 'a'.
9. **B. an** — 'An umbrella' — vowel sound.
10. **A. an hour, a university** — 'An hour' (silent h) and 'a university' ('you' sound).